

Production monitoring checklist

Module 6 - Lesson 3

Overview

Once deployed, you need visibility. Logging, structured errors, health checks, and alerting tell you what broke before users complain.

Key Concepts

- Log structured data (JSON) with request IDs so you can correlate an error to a request.
- Centralize logs and errors; store them where they are searchable.
- Health checks (/healthz) let load balancers and uptime monitors confirm the app is alive.
- Track the core metrics: errors, latency, throughput, and saturation.
- Alert on symptoms users feel (high error rate, p95 latency) rather than raw counts.
- Capture unhandled promise rejections and process crashes explicitly.

Example

```
app.use((err, req, res, next) => {  
  req.log.error({ err, route: req.originalUrl }, 'Unhandled error');  
  const status = err.status || 500;  
  res.status(status).json({  
    error: status >= 500 ? 'Internal server error' : err.message,  
  });  
});
```

Summary

Monitoring turns outages into debugging sessions. Structured logs with request IDs, health checks, and symptom-based alerting keep a production app observable.

Practice Checklist

- Add a request ID to your logs and trace one failing request.
- Create a /healthz endpoint and confirm a 200 JSON response.
- Set up an alert on the error rate rather than individual exceptions.